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Transfer device for a differential bus system

Abstract

A transfer device for a differential bus system. The transfer device includes a first bus connection and a second bus connection for connection to a transfer medium of the differential bus system, a transmitting device that is connected and/or connectable to the first bus connection and the second bus connection, and an impedance adaptation circuit that is designed to influence an impedance at the first bus connection and/or at the second bus connection.

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Background/Summary

FIELD

(1) The present invention relates to a transfer device for a differential bus system.

(2) Moreover, the present invention relates to a method for operating a transfer device for a differential bus system.

SUMMARY

(3) Exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention relate to a transfer device for a

differential bus system, including a first bus connection and a second bus connection for connection to a transfer medium of the differential bus system, for example to differential bus lines, and including a transmitting device that is connected and/or connectable to the first bus connection and the second bus connection, further including an impedance adaptation circuit that is designed to influence an impedance at the first bus connection and/or at the second bus connection. In some specific embodiments, this allows at least temporary reduction of electromagnetic emissions of the transfer device and/or greater interference immunity.

(4) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the impedance adaptation circuit is designed to influence the impedance at the first bus connection (“first impedance”) and/or at the second bus connection (“second impedance”) in such a way that the impedance at the first bus connection deviates from the impedance at the second bus connection by a maximum predefinable difference value. In further exemplary specific embodiments, this may apply, for example, for at least one predefinable frequency range, for example a subrange of an entire frequency range that is utilized by the bus system, but in other exemplary specific embodiments it may also apply, for example, for the entire frequency range that is utilized by the bus system.

(5) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, the particular impedance may have values that are, for example, at least temporarily complex, i.e., may include a nonvanishing imaginary part. Accordingly, in further exemplary specific embodiments the above-mentioned difference value may also be complex-valued, for example. In further exemplary specific embodiments, the predefinable difference value may also be purely real or purely imaginary, for example.

(6) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the impedance adaptation circuit includes at least one active semiconductor element, which in further exemplary specific embodiments allows a particularly efficient and/or precise adaptation of the first and/or second impedance.

(7) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the impedance adaptation circuit includes a first active semiconductor element and a second active semiconductor element, the first active semiconductor element being connected and/or connectable to the first bus connection, and the second active semiconductor element being connected and/or connectable to the second bus connection.

(8) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the impedance adaptation circuit includes at least one circuit component that represents a simulation of at least one portion of the transmitting device.

(9) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, “simulation of at least one portion of the transmitting device” is understood to mean a circuit component that includes the same component types (for example, having the same component parameters or component values except for a predefinable tolerance, for example) in the same topology as the portion in question, for example the simulated portion, of the transmitting device.

(10) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the impedance adaptation circuit includes at least one circuit component that represents a complete simulation of the transmitting device.

(11) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the at least one circuit component includes a series connection made up of a first diode and a first transistor and a second transistor. In further exemplary specific embodiments, the first transistor and/or the second transistor are/is in each case designed as a field effect transistor, for example of the n-type metal oxide semiconductor (NMOS) type (n-channel MOSFET) or of the p-type metal oxide semiconductor (PMOS) type (p-channel MOSFET), or as a corresponding “high-voltage” variant of an n-channel MOSFET or p-channel MOSFET.

(12) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the first

diode of the at least one circuit component corresponds to a first diode of the at least one portion of the transmitting device, for example to a type of the first diode of the at least one portion of the transmitting device.

(13) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the first transistor of the at least one circuit component corresponds to a first transistor of the at least one portion of the transmitting device, for example to a type of the first transistor of the at least one portion of the transmitting device.

(14) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the second transistor of the at least one circuit component corresponds to a second transistor of the at least one portion of the transmitting device, for example to a type of the second transistor of the at least one portion of the transmitting device.

(15) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the transfer device includes a receiving device, as a result of which the transfer device may operate, for example at least temporarily, as a transceiver. The principle according to the specific embodiments advantageously allows comparatively low electromagnetic emissions, for example during a reception of signals by the optional receiving device.

(16) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the bus system includes one of the following types: controller area network (CAN), CAN flexible data rate (CAN FD), CAN FD signal improvement capability (CAN FD SIC), CAN extra large (CAN XL), low-voltage differential signaling (LVDS), 10BASE-T1S.

(17) Further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention relate to a method for operating a transfer device for a differential bus system, including a first bus connection and a second bus connection for connection to a transfer medium of the differential bus system, for example to differential bus lines, and including a transmitting device that is connected and/or connectable to the first bus connection and the second bus connection, the transfer device including an impedance adaptation circuit, the method including: adapting an impedance at the first bus connection and/or at the second bus connection.

(18) In further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention, it is provided that the method and/or the transfer device associated with the method include(s) one or multiple of the aspects described above with regard to exemplary specific embodiments of the transfer device.

(19) Further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention relate to use of the transfer device according to the specific embodiments and/or of the method according to the specific embodiments for at least one of the following elements: a) adapting an impedance (the first impedance and/or the second impedance, for example) at least at the first and/or second bus connection, b) aligning, for example up to a predefinable difference value, the first impedance at the first bus connection with the second impedance at the second bus connection and/or vice versa, c) reducing electromagnetic emissions, for example upon a reception of signals with the aid of the transfer device, d) reducing errors or increasing an efficiency during an arbitration phase, for example for a bus system designed as CAN XL.

(20) Further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention result from the following description and the figures.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 schematically shows a simplified block diagram according to exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention.

(2) FIG. 2 schematically shows a simplified block diagram according to further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention.

- (3) FIG. 3 schematically shows a simplified circuit diagram according to further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention.
- (4) FIG. 4 schematically shows a simplified circuit diagram according to further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention.
- (5) FIG. 5 schematically shows a simplified flowchart according to further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention.
- (6) FIG. 6 schematically shows aspects of uses according to further exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXAMPLE EMBODIMENTS

- (7) FIG. 1 schematically shows a simplified block diagram of a differential bus system **10** for transferring signals, which is usable, for example, in technical products such as vehicles, in particular motor vehicles, manufacturing-related devices, etc.
- (8) Exemplary specific embodiments of the present invention relate to a transfer device **100** for a differential bus system **10**. Transfer device **100** includes a first bus connection **101** and a second bus connection **102** for connection to a transfer medium **12** of differential bus system **10**, for example to differential bus lines **12a**, **12b**, and a transmitting device **110** that is connected and/or connectable to first bus connection **101** and to second bus connection **102**.
- (9) In addition, transfer device **100** includes an impedance adaptation circuit **120** that is designed to influence an impedance at first bus connection **101** and/or at second bus connection **102**. In some specific embodiments, this allows at least temporary reduction of electromagnetic emissions of transfer device **100**.
- (10) In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is provided that impedance adaptation circuit **120** is designed to influence the impedance at first bus connection **101** ("first impedance $Z1$ ") and/or at second bus connection **102** ("second impedance $Z2$ ") in such a way that impedance $Z1$ at first bus connection **101** deviates from impedance $Z2$ at second bus connection **102** by a maximum predefinable difference value.
- (11) In further exemplary specific embodiments, this may apply, for example, for at least one predefinable frequency range, for example a subrange of an entire frequency range that is utilized by bus system **10** for the signal transfer, but in other exemplary specific embodiments it may also apply, for example, for the entire frequency range that is utilized by bus system **10**.
- (12) In further exemplary specific embodiments, particular impedance $Z1$, $Z2$ may have values that are, for example, at least temporarily complex, i.e., may include a nonvanishing imaginary part. Accordingly, in further exemplary specific embodiments the above-mentioned difference value may also be complex-valued, for example. In further exemplary specific embodiments, the predefinable difference value may also be purely real or purely imaginary, for example, at least temporarily.
- (13) In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is provided that impedance adaptation circuit **120** includes at least one active semiconductor element **122**, which in further exemplary specific embodiments allows a particularly efficient and/or precise adaptation of first and/or second impedance $Z1$, $Z2$.
- (14) In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is provided that transfer device **100** includes an optional receiving device **130** for receiving signals that are transferred via the bus system, as a result of which transfer device **100** may operate, for example at least temporarily, as a transceiver.
- (15) The principle according to the specific embodiments advantageously allows, for example during a reception of signals by optional receiving device **130**, comparatively low electromagnetic emissions, which in some conventional transfer devices may be caused, for example, by properties of transmitting device **110** and which may, for example, impair the electromagnetic compatibility of the conventional transfer devices.
- (16) It is also advantageous that in further exemplary specific embodiments, the principle according to the specific embodiments allows increased interference immunity, since, for example, an

identical impedance between the bus connections results in identical currents into the bus connections, so that, for example, no compensating current flows across a bus load resistor, as the result of which, for example, a distortion of a difference signal or differential signal transferred via the bus is avoided.

(17) In further exemplary specific embodiments **100a**, cf. FIG. 2, it is provided that impedance adaptation circuit **120** includes a first active semiconductor element **122a** and a second active semiconductor element **122b**, first active semiconductor element **122a** being connected and/or connectable to first bus connection **101**, and second active semiconductor element **122b** being connected and/or connectable to second bus connection **102**.

(18) Example configuration **100a** according to FIG. 2, for example together with optional receiving device **130**, may form a transceiver **100a** or a transceiver module **100a**, which in further exemplary specific embodiments also includes an optional protective device **140** for protection from overvoltages or electrostatic discharges (ESDs), and which, for example, is likewise connectable to bus lines **12a**, **12b** via bus connections **101**, **102**, for example.

(19) In further exemplary specific embodiments, transceiver module **100a** includes a terminal N_1 for a first reference potential of bus system **10**, which is a ground potential, for example. In the case of an example design of bus system **10** as a CAN bus system, terminal N_1 may be a “CAN_GND” terminal, for example.

(20) In further exemplary specific embodiments, transceiver module **100a** includes a terminal N_2 for a second reference potential of bus system **10**, which, for example, is an electrical potential associated with an operating voltage of bus system **10** and/or of transceiver module **100a**. In the case of an example design of bus system **10** as a CAN bus system, terminal N_1 may be a “CAN_SUPPLY” terminal, for example.

(21) FIG. 3 schematically shows aspects of a transmitting device **110a** and an impedance adaptation circuit **120a** according to further exemplary specific embodiments. In further exemplary specific embodiments, transmitting device **110a** includes a terminal N_3 to which a transmission signal to be sent via bus system **10** (FIG. 1) is suppliable. In further exemplary specific embodiments, transmitting device **110a** transforms the transmission signal into a differential signal and outputs the differential signal, via bus connections **101**, **102**, to transfer medium **12** (FIG. 1) of differential bus system **10**.

(22) In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is provided that impedance adaptation circuit **120a** includes at least one circuit component SK1, which represents a simulation of at least one portion TE1 of transmitting device **110a**.

(23) In further exemplary specific embodiments, “simulation of at least one portion of the transmitting device” is understood to mean a circuit component SK1 that includes the same component types (for example, having the same component parameters or component values except for a predefinable tolerance, for example) in the same topology as the portion in question, for example simulated portion TE1, of transmitting device **110a**.

(24) In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is provided that impedance adaptation circuit **120a** includes at least one circuit component SK1, SK2, SK1', SK2' or multiple circuit components which, for example with one another, represent(s) a complete simulation of transmitting device **110a**.

(25) In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is provided that the at least one circuit component SK1 includes a series connection made up of a first diode D1' and a first transistor T1' and a second transistor T2', for example first transistor T1' corresponding to the at least one active semiconductor element **122a** described above as an example. In further exemplary specific embodiments, first transistor T1' and/or second transistor T2' are/is in each case designed as a field effect transistor, for example of the n-type metal oxide semiconductor (NMOS) type (n-channel MOSFET) or of the p-type metal oxide semiconductor (PMOS) type (p-channel MOSFET), or as a corresponding “high-voltage” variant of an n-channel MOSFET or p-channel MOSFET.

(26) In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is provided that first diode **D1'** of the at least one circuit component **SK1** corresponds to a first diode **D1** of the at least one portion **TE1** of transmitting device **110a**, for example to a type of first diode **D1** of the at least one portion **TE1** of transmitting device **110a**.

(27) In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is provided that first transistor **T1'** of the at least one circuit component **SK1** corresponds to a first transistor **T1** of the at least one portion **TE1** of transmitting device **110a**, for example to a type of first transistor **T1** of the at least one portion **TE1** of transmitting device **110a**.

(28) In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is provided that second transistor **T2'** of the at least one circuit component **SK1** corresponds to a second transistor **T2** of the at least one portion **TE1** of transmitting device **110a**, for example to a type of second transistor **T2** of the at least one portion **TE1** of transmitting device **110a**.

(29) The at least one circuit component **SK1** of impedance adaptation circuit **120** thus represents, for example, a simulation of portion **TE1** of transmitting device **110a**. In further exemplary specific embodiments, the same applies for circuit component **SK2** with regard to portion **TE2** of transmitting device **110a**.

(30) In further exemplary specific embodiments, the same applies for further circuit component **SK1'** with regard to portion **TE1'** of transmitting device **110a**, for example including the circuit components: terminal **N_2**, a current source **SQ1** that is connected to terminal **N_2**, transistor **T3**, RC network **RC1**. In other words, in further exemplary specific embodiments, further circuit component **SK1'** includes a simulation of portion **TE1'** of transmitting device **110a**, and for example further circuit component **SK2'** includes a simulation of portion **TE2'** of transmitting device **110a**.

(31) In further exemplary specific embodiments, with their portions **TE1**, **TE2**, **TE1'**, **TE2'**, circuit components **SK1**, **SK2**, **SK1'**, **SK2'** of impedance adaptation circuit **120** according to FIG. 3 thus represent a complete simulation of transmitting device **110a**.

(32) In further exemplary specific embodiments, first transistor **T1** is an n-channel MOSFET, for example a “high-voltage” n-channel MOSFET, for example the same as transistor **T1'** of impedance adaptation circuit **120a**, which corresponds thereto as an example. In further exemplary specific embodiments, second transistor **T2** is an n-channel MOSFET, for example the same as transistor **T2'** of impedance adaptation circuit **120a**, which corresponds thereto as an example.

(33) In further exemplary specific embodiments, diode **D1** is provided as polarity reversal protection. In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is used, for example, among other things, to decouple the substrate diodes of the subsequent components of series connection **D1**, **T1**, **T2** (for example, a drain terminal from transistor **T1** to a substrate) from bus connection **102**, and thus to allow, for example, “insusceptibility” (for example, tolerance to bus voltages of different polarities).

(34) In further exemplary specific embodiments, transistor **T4** is designed as a p-channel MOSFET, for example a “high-voltage” p-channel MOSFET, for example to decouple the cathode of diode **D3**, via its substrate diode, from bus connection **101**.

(35) In further exemplary specific embodiments, transistor **T5** is designed as a p-channel MOSFET.

(36) FIG. 4 schematically shows aspects of a transmitting device **110b** and an impedance adaptation circuit **120b** according to further exemplary specific embodiments. While transmitting device **110b** has a structure or topology that is comparable to transmitting device **110a** according to FIG. 3, impedance adaptation circuit **120b** according to FIG. 4, compared to impedance adaptation circuit **120a** according to FIG. 3, is reduced, for example, in such a way that, for example, circuit components **SK1'**, **SK2'** according to FIG. 3 are not present in impedance adaptation circuit **120b** according to FIG. 4. Impedance adaptation circuit **120b** according to FIG. 4 thus includes circuit components **SK1**, **SK2** that simulate portions **TE1**, **TE2** of transmitting device **110b**, but not further portions **TE1'**, **TE2'** of transmitting device **110b**.

(37) In further exemplary specific embodiments, impedance adaptation circuit **120b** according to FIG. **4** may also be used to make an at least partial adaptation of impedances **Z1**, **Z2** (FIG. **1**), for example, in such a way that undesirable emissions, for example in a receiving operation of a transfer device that includes transmitting device **110b** and impedance adaptation circuit **120b**, are reduced. Due to the smaller number of components, specific embodiment **110b** according to FIG. **4** has smaller surface area requirements of, for example, a substrate (made of silicon, for example) that is usable for the implementation, compared to specific embodiment **110a** according to FIG. **3**.

(38) In further exemplary specific embodiments, impedance adaptation circuit **120**, **120a**, **120b** accordingly forms a simulation or copy of transmitting device **110**, **110a**, **110b**, for example circuit components **SK1**, **SK2** (FIG. **3**) being inversely connected with regard to bus connections **101**, **102**, compared to portions **TE1**, **TE2** of transmitting device **110a** which are simulated by the circuit components. For example, the series connection made up of components **D1'**, **T1'**, **T2'** (corresponding to circuit component **SK1**) is connected to first bus connection **101**, whereas circuit portion **TE1** of transmitting device **110a**, which is simulated by circuit component **SK1**, is connected to second bus connection **102** (see, for example, the anode, not described in greater detail, of diode **D1**). In further exemplary specific embodiments, this correspondingly applies for circuit component **SK2** (at bus connection **102**) and portion **TE2** (at bus connection **101**).

(39) Due to the above-described interconnection of components **SK1**, **SK2**, **TE1**, **TE2** with regard to bus connections **101**, **102**, in further exemplary specific embodiments, for example a receiving transceiver **100a** (FIG. **2**) with regard to bus connections **101**, **102** (for example, **CANH** and **CANL** for a CAN bus system **10**) also has same impedance **Z1**, **Z2** (FIG. **1**) at its “transmitter” **110a** (which is passive during a receiving operation), and its influence on the emission result is thus reduced or eliminated.

(40) In further exemplary specific embodiments, impedance adaptation circuit **120**, **120a**, **120b**, which for example represents a simulation or copy of transmitting device **110**, **110a**, **110b**, is not, for example not at any time, transferred into an active operating mode (comparable to sending via bus connections **101**, **102**), which in further exemplary specific embodiments may take place at least temporarily, for example for a desired sending operation, for transmitting device **110**, **110a**, **110b**. In FIG. **3** this is symbolized by way of example in that no activation signal acts on switches **S1'**, **S2'**, which thus remain open, for example always, for example in contrast to corresponding switches **S1**, **S2** of transmitting device **110a**, which are acted on by the transmission signal from terminal **N_3**.

(41) In further exemplary specific embodiments, it is provided that bus system **10** (FIG. **1**) includes one of the following types: controller area network (CAN), CAN flexible data rate (CAN FD), CAN FD signal improvement capability (CAN FD SIC), CAN extra large (CAN XL), low-voltage differential signaling (LVDS), 10BASE-T1S. In further exemplary specific embodiments, bus system **10** may also include some type other than the types mentioned above by way of example, which includes a differential signal transfer.

(42) Further exemplary specific embodiments, FIG. **5**, relate to a method for operating a transfer device **100** (FIG. **1**) for a differential bus system **10**, including a first bus connection **101** and a second bus connection **102** for connection to a transfer medium **12** of differential bus system **10**, for example to differential bus lines **12a**, **12b**, and including a transmitting device **110** that is connected and/or connectable to first bus connection **101** and second bus connection **102**, transfer device **100** including an impedance adaptation circuit **120**, the method including: adapting **200** (FIG. **5**) an impedance **Z1**, **Z2** at first bus connection **101** and/or at second bus connection **102**.

(43) Optional further block **202** from FIG. **5** symbolizes an optional further operation of transfer device **100**, which may involve, for example, a transmission and/or reception of signals with regard to differential bus system **10**.

(44) Further exemplary specific embodiments, FIG. **6**, relate to use **300** of the transfer device according to the specific embodiments and/or of the method according to the specific embodiments

for at least one of the following elements: a) adapting **302** an impedance (for example, first impedance **Z1** and/or second impedance **Z2**) at least at first and/or second bus connection **101**, **102**, b) aligning **304**, for example up to a predefinable difference value, first impedance **Z1** at first bus connection **101** with second impedance **Z2** at second bus connection **102** and/or vice versa, c) reducing **306** electromagnetic emissions, for example upon reception of signals with the aid of the transfer device, d) reducing **308** errors or increasing an efficiency during an arbitration phase, for example for a bus system **10** designed as CAN XL.

Claims

1. A transfer device for a differential bus system, comprising: a first bus connection and a second bus connection for connection to a transfer medium of the differential bus system; a transmitting device that is connected and/or connectable to the first bus connection and the second bus connection; and an impedance adaptation circuit that is configured to control an impedance at the first bus connection and/or an impedance at the second bus connection, wherein the control is based on a predefined or predefinable impedance difference value of a difference between the respective impedances at the first and second bus connections.
2. The transfer device as recited in claim 1, wherein the transfer medium includes differential bus lines.
3. The transfer device as recited in claim 1, wherein the impedance adaptation circuit includes at least one active semiconductor element.
4. The transfer device as recited in claim 1, further comprising a receiving device.
5. The transfer device as recited in claim 1, wherein the bus system includes one of the following types of bus systems: CAN, CAN FD, CAN FD SIC, CAN XL, LVDS, 10BASE-T1S.
6. A method for operating a transfer device for a differential bus system, the transfer device including a first bus connection and a second bus connection for connection to a transfer medium of the differential bus system, and including a transmitting device that is connected and/or connectable to the first bus connection and the second bus connection, the transfer device including an impedance adaptation circuit, the method comprising the following: controlling an impedance at the first bus connection and/or an impedance at the second bus connection, wherein the control is based on a predefined or predefinable impedance difference value of a difference between the respective impedances at the first and second bus connections.
7. The method as recited in claim 6, further comprising using the method for at least one of the following: a) aligning the first impedance at the first bus connection with the second impedance at the second bus connection, b) reducing electromagnetic emissions upon a reception of signals using the transfer device, and c) reducing errors or increasing an efficiency during an arbitration phase for a CAN XL bus system.
8. A transfer device for a differential bus system, comprising: a first bus connection and a second bus connection for connection to a transfer medium of the differential bus system; a transmitting device that is connected and/or connectable to the first bus connection and the second bus connection; and an impedance adaptation circuit that is configured to influence an impedance at the first bus connection and/or at the second bus connection; wherein the transfer device includes at least one of the following three features (I)-(III): (I) the influence of the impedance for which the impedance adaptation circuit is configured is an influence of the impedance at the first bus connection and/or the second bus connection that ensures that the impedance at the first bus connection does not deviate from the impedance at the second bus connection by more than a maximum predefinable difference value; (II) the impedance adaptation circuit includes a first active semiconductor element that is connected and/or connectable to the first bus connection and a second active semiconductor element that is connected and/or connectable to the second bus connection; and (III) the impedance adaptation circuit includes at least one circuit component that

represents a simulation of at least one portion of the transmitting device.

9. The transfer device as recited in claim 8, wherein the transfer device comprises at least feature (I) of the three features (I)-(III).

10. The transfer device as recited in claim 8, wherein the transfer device comprises at least feature (II) of the three features (I)-(III).

11. The transfer device as recited in claim 8, wherein the transfer device comprises at least feature (III) of the three features (I)-(III).

12. The transfer device as recited in claim 11, wherein the impedance adaptation circuit includes at least one circuit component that represents a complete simulation of the transmitting device.

13. The transfer device as recited in claim 12, wherein the at least one circuit component includes a series connection made up of a first diode, a first transistor, and a second transistor.

14. The transfer device as recited in claim 13, wherein: a) the first diode of the at least one circuit component corresponds to a first diode of the at least one portion of the transmitting device, and/or b) the first transistor of the at least one circuit component corresponds to a first transistor of the at least one portion of the transmitting device, and/or c) the second transistor of the at least one circuit component corresponds to a second transistor of the at least one portion of the transmitting device.
